

MHCP Mentor Workshop: What Makes a World Go Viral?

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Learn what it takes to go viral! In this session, Laex05 shares the practical, data-driven strategies behind the experiences that keep players coming back for more.

You Will Learn To:

- Design intuitive player experiences with proven retention systems
- Build seamlessly across VR and mobile
- Leverage the Horizon algorithm to your advantage

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Agenda

The Basics

Example Worlds

Horizon Algorithm

Progressive Depth

Recommendations

Q&A

The Basics

Make your users feel something, allow them to create action!

- FX: Visual, Sound, Haptics
- Pop Ups
- Motion, Scale

These super simple and easy to implement features create addictive loops, you'll want to keep doing over and over, it is a primal feeling. Use all FX, always.

Example Worlds

Let's quickly look at examples of viral hit worlds, and see what they did that worked.

Hit People Simulator

Let's rip the bandaid off early, this is actually a great world.

Here's why:

- Four Player Social Experience
- Create Action
- Be Creative: Tell Your Own Story

Go into top worlds, look and listen.



Murder Village, Murder Manor, & Spin The Bottle

What do these three worlds have in common?

- You Want To Be It
 - Random Selection => Play For Longer
- Social Experiences
 - Unique Experience Based On Group



Murder Manor

What retention tactics were implemented?

- Daily Streak
- Leveling Up
- Daily Reward Box
- Random Roles
 - $> \frac{1}{5}$ Chance + $\frac{1}{n}$ Chance
- Winning > 50%
- Easy To Play
- Growing Depth
 - Key & Weapon Positions
 - Reward & Power Up Boxes
 - Become Sheriff



Power Wash & Pop Pop

What are these worlds?

- Progressive Difficulty
 - Good Insanity
 - Satisfying Effects
 - User Upgrades
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- Difficult To Balance



Splash & Horizon Royale

There is so much I could say about these two worlds, it could be a talk on its own, but here are a few key takeaways:

- Social Hangout Space
- Unique Mechanics
- Eventual Death
- Player Motion => Uncomfortable
- Royale Was Over Complicated



Horizon Algorithm

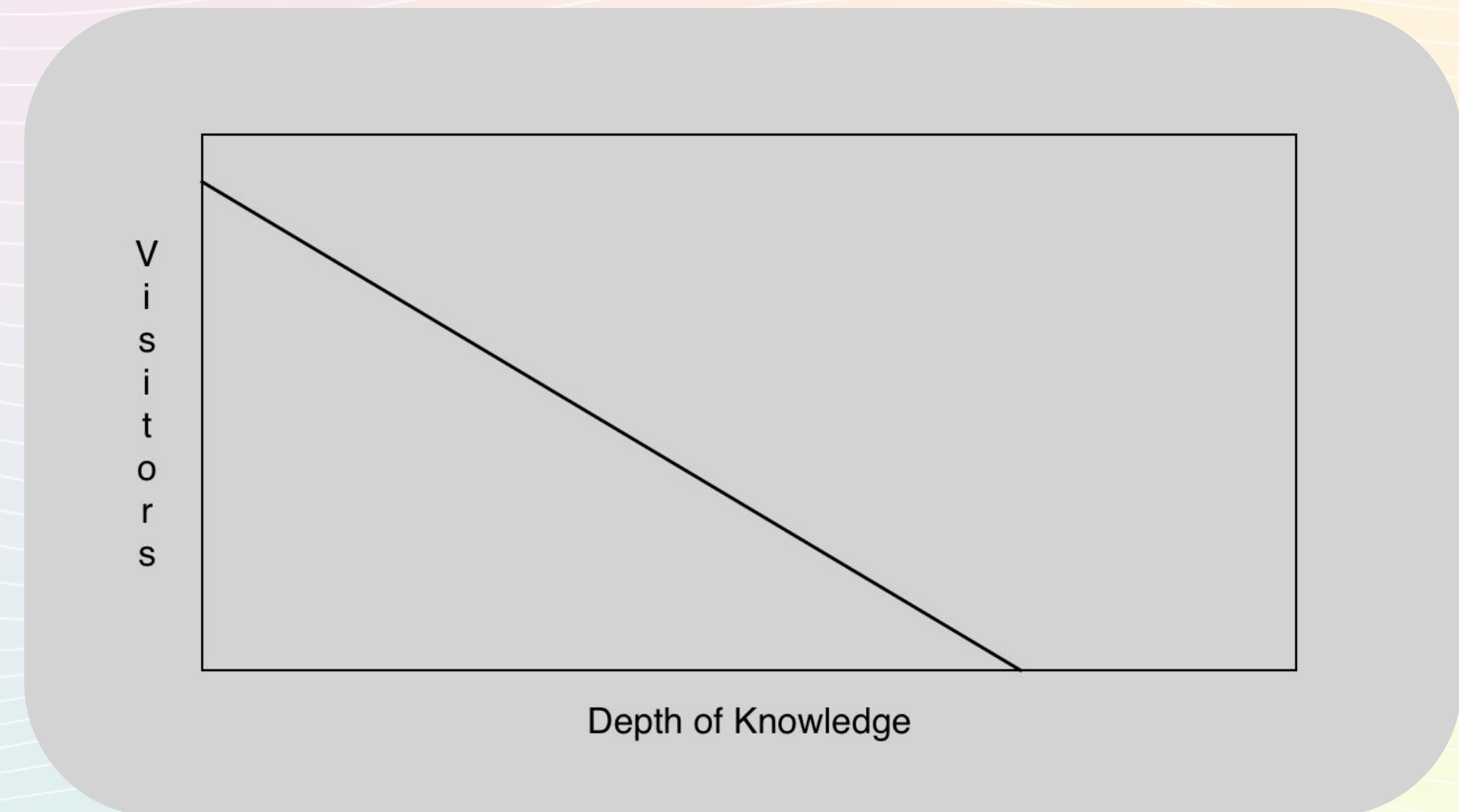
For mobile game development:

- Under 20 Seconds To Fun
- Mini Loops & Major Loops
- 5 - 15 Minute Average Session Length
- Return Within 7 Days
- Return Weekly For At Least 4 Weeks

Progressive Depth

Depth refers to the knowledge users have of your world and how to play:

- More Visitors => Less Depth
- Little Depth Required
- Retain The Users And Grow Their Depth



Recommendations

It is highly recommended you learn and apply:

- Mobile World Development
 - Mobile vs. VR First: Ability To Go Back & Forth
- In World Purchases
 - Currency, Power Ups
- Typescript
- Custom Model Import

Key Takeaways

- Effects & Action
- Mini & Major Loops
- Social Creativity
- Randomness => Retention
- Keep It Simple
- Little Depth Required => Gained Over Time

Thank You!

